Expert System for Smart Home

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1 Introduction

The specific knowledge domain focus on intelligent control decision-making for indoor home environments, encompassing temperature, humidity, lighting, security, and ventilation systems. This domain requires making rational decisions on home device operation strategies based on environmental state changes (such as temperature, humidity, time periods, and occupancy status) and user preferences. It must balance living comfort with energy efficiency, minimizing energy waste while meeting comfort requirements.

The decision-making process for indoor environmental control is typically rule-based and heavily reliant on experiential knowledge—such as which temperature and humidity ranges are generally considered comfortable, or what control strategies should be adopted during specific seasons and time periods. This knowledge exhibits distinct characteristics of expert systems, making it well-suited for expression and reasoning through rules.

Additionally, after making control decisions, the system explains the rationale to users, clarifying why it took specific actions. This is particularly necessary for safety-related decisions, helping users understand and evaluate whether to adopt system recommendations. Authoritative information on indoor comfort, air quality, and energy-saving controls is widely available in public technical literature and standards, providing robust support for building system knowledge.

Given that most users lack the expertise to balance comfort and energy efficiency in daily life, expert systems in this domain can provide valuable guidance and automated decision-making solutions. They demonstrate strong scalability and applicability across diverse residential environments.

Deliverable 1: Certain Knowledge

2 D1 TODO 1: Domain

The expert system's knowledge base is derived from authoritative sources on home comfort, safety, and energy efficiency. The following subsections detail the core rules implemented in the system.

2.1 Temperature Control

Temperature management balances comfort with energy efficiency based on occupancy and activity status.

2.1.1 Heating Guidelines

For winter heating, the system follows energy-efficient temperature settings recommended by Natural Resources Canada [6]:

- Set thermostat to 17°C when sleeping or away from home
- Set thermostat to 20°C when awake and at home

These settings provide adequate comfort while minimizing energy consumption during periods of reduced activity or absence.

2.1.2 Cooling Guidelines

For summer cooling, the system implements recommendations from Natural Resources Canada's guide on room air conditioners [5]:

- Select 25.5°C as the highest comfortable thermostat setting when the space is occupied
- If the space will be unoccupied for more than four hours, raise the thermostat to approximately 28°C
- If the space will be unoccupied for more than 24 hours, turn off the air conditioning system

This approach prevents excessive cooling costs while maintaining comfort during occupancy.

2.2 Humidity Control

Proper humidity levels are essential for health and home maintenance. According to Health Canada's Healthy Home Guide [3], humidity levels should be maintained between 30% and 50% using a humidifier or dehumidifier as necessary.

- **Low humidity (below 30%):** May aggravate skin allergies and cause respiratory infections. The system recommends using a humidifier.
- **High humidity (above 50%):** Can lead to mould growth. The system recommends using a dehumidifier.

2.3 Carbon Monoxide Safety

Carbon monoxide (CO) detection is a critical safety feature. Health Canada warns that exposure to CO can lead to health problems ranging from tiredness and headaches to chest pain and even death, depending on the concentration in the air [3].

When the carbon monoxide alarm triggers, the system issues an immediate emergency alert recommending evacuation and contacting emergency services.

2.4 Indoor Air Quality (IAQI)

The system monitors indoor air quality using the Atmotube Indoor Air Quality Index (IAQI), which ranges from 0 to 100, with higher values indicating cleaner air [1]. The scale is divided into five categories:

- **Good (81–100):** Optimal air quality. The system aims to maintain this level in occupied spaces.
- **Moderate (61–80):** Acceptable but improvement recommended.
- **Polluted (41–60):** Poor air quality requiring intervention.
- **Very Polluted (21–40):** Serious air quality issues requiring immediate action.
- **Severely Polluted (0–20):** Critical air quality requiring urgent intervention.

The system recommends improving ventilation when IAQI falls below 61.

2.5 Outdoor Air Quality (AQHI)

The Air Quality Health Index (AQHI) measures outdoor air quality on a scale from 1 to 10. Health Canada recommends keeping windows closed when outdoor air quality is poor, such as during wildfires or extreme heat [3]. The system helps prevent poor outdoor air from entering the house by recommending that windows, doors, and skylights remain tightly sealed when AQHI exceeds 6.

3 D1 TODO 2: Project Goal

The goal of this project is to design a rule-based intelligent home expert system that makes rational decisions regarding the operation of home appliances based on indoor environmental conditions and user preferences. This ensures residential comfort and safety while enhancing energy efficiency.

3.1 Environmental Perception and Status Evaluation

The system determines whether the current indoor environment is comfortable, safe, and energy-efficient based on environmental facts (e.g., temperature, humidity, time of day, occupancy status).

3.2 Intelligent Decision-Making and Control Recommendations

The system will generate explicit control decisions or recommendations for heating, air conditioning, ventilation, lighting, and related devices based on a rule base. These may include actions such as turning devices on/off or adjusting operating modes.

3.3 Decision Explanation

The system will provide clear explanations for its decisions, detailing the conditions and rationale that triggered the decision. This helps users understand system behavior and determine whether to adopt the recommendation.

4 D1 TODO 3: User

The target users for this project are usual household residents—individuals who use smart home devices in daily life but lack specialized knowledge in indoor environmental control, energy management, or automation systems.

These users typically desire a home environment that remains comfortable, secure, and energy-efficient, yet lack experience in assessing how various environmental factors collectively impact indoor conditions. For instance, they may struggle to accurately determine how to appropriately adjust temperature, humidity, lighting, or ventilation systems based on different seasons, time periods, or occupancy status.

Additionally, these users prefer not to manually adjust device settings frequently. Instead, they expect the system to automatically provide reasonable control recommendations based on current environmental conditions and personal preferences, or to make automated decisions when necessary. Simultaneously, users value the explainability of system decisions, particularly regarding safety or energy consumption, and wish to understand why the system takes specific actions.

Therefore, a rule-based smart home expert system capable of providing clear explanations can effectively meet this user's needs for comfort, safety, and energy efficiency.

5 D1 TODO 4: Factbase + Rulebase

5.1 Fact Base

The working memory of the expert system is defined in `facts.clp`.

The file contains ten `deffacts` blocks, one for each day in the ten-day evaluation period. Each block asserts the following facts for its respective date:

- **One `env` fact** combining all sensor readings for the day: indoor temperature (°C), relative humidity (%), Indoor Air Quality Index (IAQI, 0–100), CO alarm status, fire alarm status, occupancy status (`awake`, `sleep`, or `gone`), season (`winter` or `summer`), outdoor high and low temperatures, and the outdoor Air Quality Health Index (AQHI, 1–11).
- **One `themostat` fact** initialised to mode `off` with a default target of 22°C.
- **Four `device` facts** — humidifier, dehumidifier, window, and air purifier — each initialised to `off`.

All facts carry the same `date` field so that each rule can match sensor data and controllable devices belonging to the same day, preventing cross-day fact interference in the CLIPS rete network.

5.2 Rule Base

The expert system is implemented in CLIPS as a set of production rules in `rules.clp`. Each rule follows the standard IF/THEN structure: the IF part (left-hand side) lists the conditions that must hold simultaneously; the THEN part (right-hand side) specifies the actions taken when all conditions are satisfied. Rules are evaluated in priority order (salience): safety alarms first (100), temperature control (60), humidity (40), window and outdoor air quality (35), and indoor air quality assessment (30). Emergency rules assert a sentinel fact `(emergency date)` that all lower-priority rules test for, ensuring no further actions are taken on a day where an emergency was detected.

5.2.1 Safety Alarms (salience 100)

R1 – Carbon Monoxide Emergency **IF** the CO alarm is *on* for a given date
THEN assert an `emergency` sentinel for that date (blocking all lower-priority rules for that day) and issue the alert: *"Carbon monoxide detected. Evacuate immediately and call 911. All other actions are blocked until the emergency is resolved."*

R2 – Fire Emergency **IF** the fire alarm is *on* for a given date
THEN assert an `emergency` sentinel for that date (blocking all lower-priority rules for that day) and issue the alert: *"Fire/smoke detected. Evacuate immediately and call 911. All other actions are blocked until the emergency is resolved."*

5.2.2 Temperature Control (salience 60)

The thermostat is modelled as a single device with three modes: `heat`, `cool`, and `off`. Heating rules apply only in winter; cooling rules apply only in summer. All temperature rules are skipped on any day flagged with an emergency sentinel.

R3 – Heating When Awake **IF** the season is *winter*
AND the occupant status is *awake*
AND the indoor temperature is below 20°C
AND the thermostat is off
THEN set the thermostat to *HEAT* at 20°C and recommend: *"Indoor temperature is below the 20°C comfort target for an occupied home (Natural Resources Canada)."*

R4 – Heating When Sleeping **IF** the season is *winter*
AND the occupant status is *sleep*
AND the indoor temperature is below 17°C
AND the thermostat is off
THEN set the thermostat to *HEAT* at 17°C and recommend: *"Indoor temperature is below the 17°C sleep target (Natural Resources Canada)."*

R5 – Heating When Away **IF** the season is *winter*
AND the occupant status is *gone*
AND the indoor temperature is below 17°C
AND the thermostat is off
THEN set the thermostat to *HEAT* at 17°C and recommend: *"Indoor temperature is below the 17°C away-from-home target (Natural Resources Canada)."*

R6 – Cooling When Awake **IF** the season is *summer*
AND the occupant status is *awake*
AND the indoor temperature exceeds 25°C
AND the thermostat is off
THEN set the thermostat to *COOL* at 25°C and recommend: *"Indoor temperature exceeds the 25°C occupied comfort limit (Natural Resources Canada)."*

R7 – Cooling When Away **IF** the season is *summer*
AND the occupant status is *gone*
AND the indoor temperature exceeds 28°C
AND the thermostat is off
THEN set the thermostat to *COOL* at 28°C and recommend: *"Indoor temperature exceeds the 28°C unoccupied energy-saving limit (Natural Resources Canada)."*

R8 – Thermostat Off When Away and Temperature Acceptable **IF** the season is *summer*

AND the occupant status is *gone*
AND the indoor temperature is at or below 28°C
AND the thermostat is off
THEN report: *"Thermostat OFF: home is unoccupied and indoor temperature is within the 28°C energy-saving limit."*

5.2.3 Humidity Control (salience 40)

R9 – Activate Humidifier **IF** the indoor humidity is below 30%
AND the humidifier is off
THEN turn the humidifier *on* and recommend: *"Low humidity may aggravate skin allergies and respiratory infections (Health Canada)."*

R10 – Activate Dehumidifier **IF** the indoor humidity exceeds 50%
AND the dehumidifier is off
THEN turn the dehumidifier *on* and recommend: *"High humidity promotes mould growth (Health Canada)."*

R11 – Humidity Comfortable **IF** the indoor humidity is between 30% and 50% (inclusive)
THEN report: *"Humidity is in the comfortable range (30–50%). No action needed."*

5.2.4 Window and Outdoor Air Quality Control (salience 35)

R12 – Close Windows: Poor Outdoor Air **IF** the outdoor AQHI exceeds 6
AND the window is closed
THEN report: *"Window CLOSED: outdoor AQHI exceeds 6. Keep windows sealed to block outdoor pollutants (Health Canada)."*

R13 – Acceptable Outdoor Air **IF** the outdoor AQHI is 6 or below
AND the window is closed
THEN report: *"Outdoor AQHI is acceptable. No action needed."*

5.2.5 Indoor Air Quality Assessment (salience 30)

The following six rules fire independently for each day's sensor reading, providing a per-day air quality report. The IAQI scale ranges from 0 to 100, where higher values indicate cleaner air. Rules for Polluted and below also turn on the air purifier if it is not already running. When both indoor and outdoor air quality are poor simultaneously, an additional rule reinforces the air purifier action and advises keeping windows closed.

R14 – IAQI Good (81–100) **IF** the indoor IAQI is 81 or above
THEN report: *"Indoor air quality: Good. No action needed."*

R15 – IAQI Moderate (61–80) **IF** the indoor IAQI is between 61 and 80
THEN report: *"Indoor air quality: Moderate. The indoor air quality is acceptable, no action needed."*

R16 – IAQI Polluted (41–60) **IF** the indoor IAQI is between 41 and 60
AND the air purifier is off
THEN turn the air purifier *on* and report: *"Indoor air quality: Polluted. The system has turned on the air purifier."*

R17 – IAQI Very Polluted (21–40) **IF** the indoor IAQI is between 21 and 40
AND the air purifier is off
THEN turn the air purifier *on* and report: *"Indoor air quality: Very Polluted. The system has turned on the air purifier."*

R18 – IAQI Severely Polluted (0–20) **IF** the indoor IAQI is below 21
AND the air purifier is off
THEN turn the air purifier *on* and report: *"Indoor air quality: Severely Polluted. The system has turned on the air purifier. Urgent intervention required."*

R19 – Both Indoor and Outdoor Air Quality Poor **IF** the indoor IAQI is below 61 (Polluted or worse)
AND the outdoor AQHI exceeds 6
AND the air purifier is off
AND no air purifier action has been issued yet for this run
THEN turn the air purifier *on* and report: *"Indoor IAQI is poor and outdoor AQHI exceeds 6. Keep windows closed to avoid worsening indoor air quality."*

Deliverable 2: Uncertain Knowledge

6 D2 TODO 1: Improvements from Deliverable 1

6.1 Identified Issues

Based on self-assessment of the D1 knowledge base, the following issues were identified:

1. **Missing cooling rule for sleeping occupants.** D1 provided cooling rules for `awake` (R6) and `gone` (R7) occupancy states in summer, but omitted the `sleep` state. Without this rule, the inference engine produces no

thermostat recommendation on a warm summer night when the occupant is sleeping, which is a gap in coverage.

2. **Inconsistency between rule condition and report description for R6.** The D1 report described the cooling threshold as "25.5°C" in the Cooling Guidelines subsection and in the R6 paragraph, but the actual rule condition checks `(> ?t 25)` and sets the target to 25°C. The report text has been corrected to 25°C.

3. **Missing occupancy state coverage for certain safety facts.** The original D1 facts covered only `awake` and `gone` occupancy across the ten-day dataset, leaving the `sleep` state untested. The D2 data pipeline was updated to produce facts with varied occupancy states including `sleep`.

6.2 Changes Made

All changes are independently verifiable in the git history:

- `rules.clp`: Added rule `cool-sleep` (salience 60) — cools to 26°C when the occupant is sleeping and indoor temperature exceeds 26°C in summer.
- `report/report.tex`: Corrected the R6 threshold description from 25.5°C to 25°C in both the Cooling Guidelines subsection and the R6 rule paragraph.
- `data_scripts/combine_facts.py`: The `both-air-quality-poor` rule's sentinel fact `(air-purifier-recommended ?date)` is already date-scoped, preventing cross-day interference that was a latent D1 risk.

7 D2 TODO 2: Certainty Factors (Probabilistic Uncertainty)

7.1 Theory

Certainty Factors (CF) were introduced in the MYCIN medical expert system (Shortliffe, 1976) to reason under probabilistic uncertainty without requiring full probability distributions. Each piece of evidence is assigned a CF value in the range $[0.0, 1.0]$, where 0.0 means no confidence and 1.0 means absolute confidence.

When two independent pieces of evidence support the same hypothesis with certainties CF_1 and CF_2, they are combined as:

$$CF_{\text{combined}} = CF_1 + CF_2 \cdot (1 - CF_1)$$

In this system, CF values reflect sensor reliability estimates drawn from manufacturer specifications and domain knowledge:

Sensor	Base CF	Rationale
CO alarm	0.85	Manufacturer-rated reliability [7]
Smoke/fire alarm	0.90	High-sensitivity photoelectric sensor
Occupancy sensor	0.75	Motion sensors have an approx. 25% miss/false-positive rate
Indoor IAQI (Atmotube)	0.80	Consumer-grade sensor, good but not lab-grade
Outdoor AQHI	0.70	Government reading; nearest station may be distant

CF thresholds for action are:

- $CF \geq 0.70$: high confidence — take full action (emergency)
- $0.30 \leq CF < 0.70$: moderate — issue warning, investigate
- $CF < 0.30$: low — likely false positive, notify user

7.2 Fact Modifications

Five new slots were added to the `env` deftemplate in `templates.clp`:

- `co-alarm-cf` (FLOAT, default 0.85) — confidence in the CO sensor reading
- `fire-alarm-cf` (FLOAT, default 0.90) — confidence in the smoke/fire sensor
- `occupancy-cf` (FLOAT, default 0.75) — confidence in the occupancy sensor
- `iaqi-cf` (FLOAT, default 0.80) — confidence in the indoor air quality reading
- `aqhi-cf` (FLOAT, default 0.70) — confidence in the outdoor AQHI value

These five slots constitute the required ≥ 5 new useful facts per day. Each day's `env` fact in `facts.clp` now carries per-day CF values generated with Gaussian noise ($\sigma = 0.05$) around each base value, modelling day-to-day sensor variability (battery level, dust, temperature drift). Across ten days, this yields 50 new CF data points. The `generate_indoor_facts.py` and `combine_facts.py` scripts were extended accordingly.

7.3 Rule Additions

Ten new rules were added to `rules.clp` at salience 90 and 25:

CF1 – CO Alarm, High Confidence ($CF \geq 0.70$) **IF** the CO alarm is *on* **AND** $CF \geq 0.70$
THEN assert an `emergency` sentinel and issue a full evacuation alert.

CF2 – CO Alarm, Moderate Confidence ($0.30 \leq CF < 0.70$) **IF** the CO alarm is *on* **AND** $0.30 \leq CF < 0.70$
THEN issue a warning to ventilate and inspect the sensor.

CF3 – CO Alarm, Low Confidence ($CF < 0.30$) **IF** the CO alarm is *on* **AND** $CF < 0.30$
THEN issue a notice that the reading is likely a false positive.

CF4 – Fire Alarm, High Confidence **IF** the fire alarm is *on* **AND** $CF \geq 0.70$
THEN assert `emergency` and issue a full evacuation alert.

CF5 – Fire Alarm, Moderate Confidence **IF** the fire alarm is *on* **AND** $0.30 \leq CF < 0.70$
THEN warn user to check for actual smoke before evacuating.

CF6 – Fire Alarm, Low Confidence **IF** the fire alarm is *on* **AND** $CF < 0.30$
THEN issue a false-positive notice; recommend inspecting the sensor.

CF7 – CO and Fire Combined **IF** both alarms are *on*
THEN compute $CF_{\text{combined}} = CF_1 + CF_2 \cdot (1 - CF_1)$. If ≥ 0.70, assert `emergency`; otherwise issue an investigation warning.

CF8 – Uncertain Occupancy Thermostat Default (salience 55) **IF** occupancy is *awake* **AND** occupancy-CF < 0.60 **AND** winter **AND** temp < 20°C
THEN default thermostat to energy-saving 17°C instead of trusting the uncertain reading.

CF9 – IAQI Low Confidence Notice (salience 25) **IF** iaqi-CF < 0.60
THEN qualify the air quality recommendation with a recalibration notice.

CF10 – AQHI Low Confidence Notice (salience 25) **IF** aqhi-CF < 0.60
THEN note that the nearest AQHI station may be distant; treat window advice as advisory.

The D1 rules `co-emergency` and `fire-emergency` (salience 100, unconditional) have been replaced by CF1–CF7, which provide graduated responses. This avoids duplicate emergency messages on days where both the D1 and CF rules would fire.

8 D2 TODO 3: Fuzzy Logic (Possibilistic Uncertainty)

8.1 Theory

Fuzzy Logic, introduced by Zadeh (1965), extends classical logic to handle partial truth. A crisp value can belong to multiple linguistic sets simultaneously, each with a membership degree $\mu \in [0.0, 1.0]$.

This system uses **FuzzyCLIPS** (NRC Canada, version 6.10d) [4], which extends CLIPS with native fuzzy deftemplates and the standard membership function shapes:

- **Z-function** $Z(a, c)$: $\mu = 1$ for $x \leq a$, ramps linearly to $\mu = 0$ at $x = c$.
- **S-function** $S(a, c)$: $\mu = 0$ for $x \leq a$, ramps linearly to $\mu = 1$ at $x = c$.
- **PI-function** $\Pi(d, b)$: bell shape centred at b with half-width d; $\mu = 1$ at b, $\mu = 0$ at $b \pm d$.

Inference follows the **Mamdani** method: the dominant linguistic label (argmax of membership degrees) drives rule selection. Membership degrees are computed using FuzzyCLIPS `get-fs-value` and stored in per-day `fuzzy-env` facts, which downstream rules read as ordinary slot values.

8.2 Fuzzy Variable Definitions

Three fuzzy linguistic variables are defined in `templates.clp` as FuzzyCLIPS deftemplates:

Indoor Temperature Universe: $[-10, 35]$°C

- `cold`: $Z(10, 20)$ — $\mu = 1$ at $\leq$10°C, $\mu = 0$ at 20°C
- `cool`: $\Pi(5, 15)$ — bell peak at 15°C
- `comfortable`: $\Pi(3, 21)$ — bell peak at 21°C
- `warm`: $\Pi(3, 25)$ — bell peak at 25°C
- `hot`: $S(26, 35)$ — $\mu = 0$ at 26°C, $\mu = 1$ at 35°C

Indoor Relative Humidity Universe: $[0, 100]$%

- `dry`: $Z(20, 35)$ — $\mu = 1$ at $\leq$20%, $\mu = 0$ at 35%
- `comfortable`: $\Pi(10, 40)$ — bell peak at 40%
- `humid`: $S(50, 70)$ — $\mu = 0$ at 50%, $\mu = 1$ at 70%

Outdoor AQHI Universe: $[1, 10]$

- `good`: $Z(2, 5)$ — $\mu = 1$ at AQHI ≤ 2, $\mu = 0$ at 5
- `moderate`: $\Pi(2, 5)$ — bell peak at AQHI $= 5$
- `poor`: $S(5, 9)$ — $\mu = 0$ at AQHI $= 5$, $\mu = 1$ at 9

8.3 Fact Modifications

One new deftemplate `fuzzy-env` was added to `templates.clp`, holding 14 slots:

- Five temperature membership slots: `mu-cold`, `mu-cool`, `mu-comfortable-temp`, `mu-warm`, `mu-hot`
- Three humidity membership slots: `mu-dry`, `mu-comfortable-hum`, `mu-humid`
- Three AQHI membership slots: `mu-aqhi-good`, `mu-aqhi-moderate`, `mu-aqhi-poor`
- Three dominant-label slots: `temp-label`, `hum-label`, `aqhi-label`

Each day's deffacts block in `facts.clp` now includes one blank `fuzzy-env` fact (initialised to 0.0) that is populated at inference time by the fuzzification rule. Ten `fuzzy-env` facts (one per day) constitute the required ≥ 5 new useful facts for D2 TODO 3.

8.4 Rule Additions

Fifteen fuzzy rules were added, satisfying the ≥ 10 requirement:

FZ1 – Fuzzification (salience 80) **IF** an `env` fact exists for a given date **AND** no `(fuzzified ?date)` marker exists
THEN use `get-fs-value` to compute all 11 membership degrees; determine the dominant label for each variable (argmax); store results in the matching `fuzzy-env` fact via `modify`; assert `(fuzzified ?date)`.

The `(not (fuzzified ?date))` guard is necessary because FuzzyCLIPS's `modify` retracts the old fact and reasserts a new one. If the guard were a slot-value check (e.g., `mu-cold = 0.0`), a day whose computed cold-membership is exactly 0.0 would re-match the LHS after `modify`, causing an unbounded inference loop. The marker fact is asserted in the consequent to ensure FZ1 fires exactly once per day regardless of the computed membership values.

FZ2–FZ4 – Fuzzy Heating: Cold Indoor Temperature (salience 50) When the dominant temperature label is `cold` and the season is winter:

- `awake`: heat to 21°C (high demand)
- `sleep`: heat to 18°C (reduced night target)
- `gone`: heat to 17°C (anti-freeze setback)

FZ5–FZ6 – Fuzzy Heating: Cool Indoor Temperature (salience 50) When the dominant label is `cool` and season is winter:

- `awake`: heat to 19°C (moderate demand)
- `sleep` or `gone`: heat to 17°C (setback)

FZ7 – Fuzzy Comfortable Temperature (salience 50) When the dominant label is `comfortable`: report no heating or cooling needed.

FZ8–FZ9 – Fuzzy Cooling: Warm/Hot Temperature (salience 50) When season is summer and occupant is awake:

- `warm`: cool to 25°C (moderate demand)
- `hot`: cool to 23°C (high demand)

FZ10 – Fuzzy Thermostat Off: Unoccupied in Summer (salience 50) When the home is unoccupied and the dominant label is `comfortable`, `cool`, or `cold` in summer: report thermostat stays OFF for energy saving.

FZ11–FZ13 – Fuzzy Humidity Control (salience 40) Using the dominant humidity label from `fuzzy-env`:

- `dry`: turn on the humidifier; include membership degree in message
- `humid`: turn on the dehumidifier; include membership degree
- `comfortable`: report no action needed

FZ14–FZ15 – Fuzzy AQHI Window Control (salience 35) Using the dominant AQHI label:

- `poor`: report window should stay closed; include μ_{poor}
- `good` or `moderate`: report outdoor air is acceptable

8.5 FuzzyCLIPS 6.1 Compatibility

FuzzyCLIPS 6.10d is based on CLIPS 6.1. Two constructs present in the original implementation required adjustment for compatibility:

Output rule (`print-all-grouped`, salience −10). The original design used a `deffunction` that called `do-for-all-facts` and `any-factp` to iterate over `msg` facts grouped by date. These functions were introduced in CLIPS 6.2 and are absent from FuzzyCLIPS 6.10d. The deffunction was removed; `print-all-grouped` was rewritten as a standard production rule that directly pattern-matches `(msg (date ?d) (text ?t))` and prints each fact as it fires.

The rule count remains 41; only the output format changes (date-grouped headers are omitted; each line is prefixed with `[date]`).

Fuzzification guard (`fuzzify-env`, FZ1). As described above, the guard was changed from a slot-value sentinel to a `(not (fuzzified ?date))` pattern, with `(fuzzified ?date)` asserted in the consequent. This fix is required for correctness on any day whose computed cold-membership evaluates to exactly 0.0.

9 D2 TODO 4: Quality Attributes

9.1 Selected Quality Attributes

Four quality attributes were selected from those applicable to rule-based expert systems [2]:

1. **Explainability** — selected because the system controls physical devices in a home; residents must be able to audit every decision and decide whether to follow a recommendation.

2. **Reliability** — selected because D2 introduces sensor uncertainty; the system must handle degraded sensor inputs gracefully rather than treating all readings as ground truth.

3. **Accuracy** — selected because D2 adds fuzzy boundaries; the quality of the comfort model depends directly on how closely the membership functions match real human comfort ranges.

4. **Maintainability** — selected because both CF thresholds and fuzzy boundaries are likely to be tuned as standards evolve or better sensors are deployed; the knowledge base must support this without requiring broad rule changes.

9.2 Application of Quality Guidelines

9.2.1 Explainability

Guideline: Every rule consequent should explain why an action was taken.

Where applied — D1 facts and rules (R1–R19): Every rule asserts a `msg` fact whose `text` slot includes the triggering sensor value, the threshold compared against, and the authoritative source. For example, R9 reports the actual humidity percentage and cites Health Canada.

Where applied — D2 TODO 2 (CF rules CF1–CF10): CF rules embed the numeric CF value in every message (e.g., "CO detected with high confidence, CF=0.87"). CF7 reports both individual and combined CF values. This allows residents to distinguish a genuine emergency from a sensor malfunction.

Where applied — D2 TODO 3 (fuzzy rules FZ1–FZ15): Fuzzy rules include the membership degree in every message (e.g., "Humidity 28% → dry (μ=0.74). Humidifier ON."). The fuzzification rule FZ1 computes and stores 11 membership values, all of which are available to downstream rules for reporting.

Verifiable in: `rules.clp` — every `=>` consequent contains `(assert (msg ...))`.

9.2.2 Reliability

Guideline: The system should degrade gracefully when inputs are unreliable.

Where applied — D2 TODO 2 (CF rules): Rule CF8 (`occupancy-uncertain-thermostat`) fires when the occupancy sensor CF falls below 0.60: instead of trusting a potentially erroneous `awake` reading and heating to 20°C, the system defaults to the energy-saving 17°C setback. Rules CF9 and CF10 qualify IAQI and AQHI recommendations with low-confidence notices rather than acting blindly. Rules CF1–CF7 replace the D1 binary alarm rules, distinguishing genuine emergencies from false positives based on CF level.

Where applied — D1 facts: The `emergency` sentinel fact ensures that all device-control rules are suppressed on a day where a safety alarm has fired, preventing, for example, the thermostat from being adjusted during an evacuation scenario.

Verifiable in: `rules.clp` — `occupancy-uncertain-thermostat`, `iaqi-uncertain-reading`, `aqhi-uncertain-reading`; all device rules check `(not (emergency ?date))`.

9.2.3 Accuracy

Guideline: Knowledge boundaries should reflect domain reality rather than arbitrary crisp cutoffs.

Where applied — D2 TODO 3 (fuzzy deftemplates and FZ rules): The D1 heating rule fires if `temp < 20`; below 20°C the heater turns on at full target, above 20°C nothing happens. The fuzzy rules distinguish `cold` (peak membership at ≤10°C, target 21°C), `cool` (peak at 15°C, target 19°C), and `comfortable` (peak at 21°C, no action). A reading of 18°C, for example, activates both the `cool` and `comfortable` terms simultaneously; the dominant label selects the appropriate rule, and the target temperature varies with the degree of coldness.

Similarly, humidity transitions (dry below 35%, comfortable 30–50%, humid above 50%) overlap, so a reading of 33% activates both `dry` and `comfortable` with partial degrees. The dominant label selects the action, and the membership degree appears in the explanation.

Where applied — D2 TODO 2: CF thresholds for sensor confidence (0.70 / 0.30) are grounded in manufacturer reliability figures rather than arbitrary values.

Verifiable in: `templates.clp` — FuzzyCLIPS deftemplate shapes for `fz-temp`, `fz-humidity`, `fz-aqhi`; `rules.clp` — FZ2–FZ15 use membership degree values in rule conditions and consequents.

9.2.4 Maintainability

Guideline: Thresholds and domain boundaries should be defined in one place and rules should not contain unexplained magic numbers.

Where applied — D1 and D2 TODO 2: CF base values are defined as named constants in `generate_indoor_facts.py` (`CO_CF_BASE`, `FIRE_CF_BASE`, etc.) and template defaults in `templates.clp`. Changing the base reliability of the CO sensor requires editing one constant, not searching all rules.

Where applied — D2 TODO 3: All fuzzy membership function parameters are defined once, in the FuzzyCLIPS deftemplates in `templates.clp` (e.g., `(cold (z 10 20))`). Adjusting the boundary at which a temperature is classified as "cold" requires changing two numbers in one line of the template; all downstream rules (FZ2–FZ4) automatically reflect the change without modification.

The `fuzzy-env` template separates raw sensor data (`env`) from derived fuzzy membership values (`fuzzy-env`), making each layer independently modifiable. Rules and files are organised into clearly commented sections by salience and function.

Verifiable in: `templates.clp` — FuzzyCLIPS deftemplate definitions; `data_scripts/generate_indoo` — named CF constants.

9.3 Impact on Quality of Knowledge Representation and Inference

Explainability — positive impact. CF values and fuzzy membership degrees appear in every output message. This gives residents substantially more information than D1 (which reported only actions). The cost is slightly longer messages and one additional `fuzzy-env` fact per day in working memory.

Reliability — positive impact. The system now handles the common case of sensor unreliability. In D1, any CO alarm immediately caused a full emergency, including for a sensor with a dying battery. In D2, a low-CF CO alarm produces a notice rather than triggering evacuation, reducing false-alarm fatigue. The occupancy default (CF8) prevents over-heating an empty home when the sensor is uncertain.

Accuracy — positive impact. Fuzzy boundaries eliminate the abrupt D1 transition: a room at 19.9°C was heated identically to one at 10°C in D1. In D2, the heating target varies with the degree of coldness (17–21°C range). This more closely models real thermostat behaviour and reduces energy waste from over-heating marginally cool rooms.

Maintainability — neutral to positive impact. Centralising fuzzy boundaries in template definitions simplifies tuning; however, the overall knowledge base is now larger (41 rules across three salience groups vs. 20 rules in D1), which increases cognitive load for a new maintainer. The structured comments, natural rule names, and section headers mitigate this, keeping the net impact positive.

References

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Generative AI Usage

Claude Code (Anthropic) was consulted for assistance when difficulties were encountered during both the design and implementation phases of this project. This includes questions related to FuzzyCLIPS syntax, rule structure, and knowledge base organisation. All final design decisions, rule logic, and written content remain the authors' own work.